23.9 Dairy Farming

Dairy farming involves rising of cattle for milk production. It involves the proper maintenance of cattle, along with collection and processing of milk and milk products which are useful to man. Dairying is the production and marketing of milk and its products.

23.9.1 Cattle Breeds

The Indian cattle include cows and buffaloes. They are domesticated for milk, meat, leather and transportation. They belong to two different species, *Bos indicus* (Indian cows and bulls) and *Bos bubalis* (buffaloes). These cattle animals are reared for milk and farm labour. They are classified into three types: Dairy breeds, Draught (or) Draft breeds, Dual purpose breeds.

a. Dairy breeds: Dairy animals are domesticated for obtaining milk. The cows (milk producing females) are high milk yielders (**milch animals**).The dairy breeds are: a) Indigenous breeds b) Exotic breeds.

Indigenous breeds are native of India. They include **Sahiwal, Red Sindhi, Deoni** and **Gir**. These cattle are well built with strong limbs, prominent hump and loose skin. Milk production depends on the duration of the lactation period (the period of milk production after the birth of a calf). These local breed animals show excellent resistant to diseases.

Exotic breeds (*Bos taurus*) are imported from foreign countries. They include **Jersey, Brown Swiss** and **Holstein-Friesian** etc. These foreign breeds are selected for long lactation periods.

b. Draught (or) Draft breeds: They are used for agricultural work, such as tilling, irrigation and carting. These include **Amritmahal, Kangayam, Umblachery, Malvi, Siri** and **Hallikar** breeds. Bullocks are good draft animals while the cows are poor milk yielders.

c. Dual purpose breeds: The cows of these breeds provide milk and the bulls are useful for farm work. In India these breeds are favoured by farmers. They include **Haryana, Ongole, Kankrej** and **Tharparkar**.

Info bits

Indigenous Draught breeds - Native to Tamil Nadu

Kangayam: It originated in Kangayam and is observed in Dharapuram, Perundurai, Erode, Bhavani and part of Gobichettipalayam taluk of Erode and Coimbatore district.

Pulikulam: This breed is commonly seen in Cumbum valley of Madurai district in Tamil Nadu. It is also known as Jallikattu madu, They are mainly used for penning in the field and useful for ploughing.

23.9.2 Composition of Cattle Feed

The food requirement for cattle should support healthy life of the animal and milk producing requirement. The feed for dairy cattle is broadly classified into two: Roughages and Concentrates

Roughage is a coarse and fibrous fodder. It consists of succulent feed (cultivated grass, fodder and root crops) and dry fodder (hay, straw and chaff).

Concentrates are low in fibre and contain high level of carbohydrates, protein and other nutrients. A variety of raw materials such as cholam (jowar), kambu (pearl millet), ragi (finger millet), rice bran, wheat bran, cotton seed cake, mustard cake, linseed cake, groundnut cake, mango seed, neem cake and yellu (sesame) cake can be used to make concentrate feed. They should also be fed on green fodder (maize, lucerne, berseem, millet, and elephant grass).

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